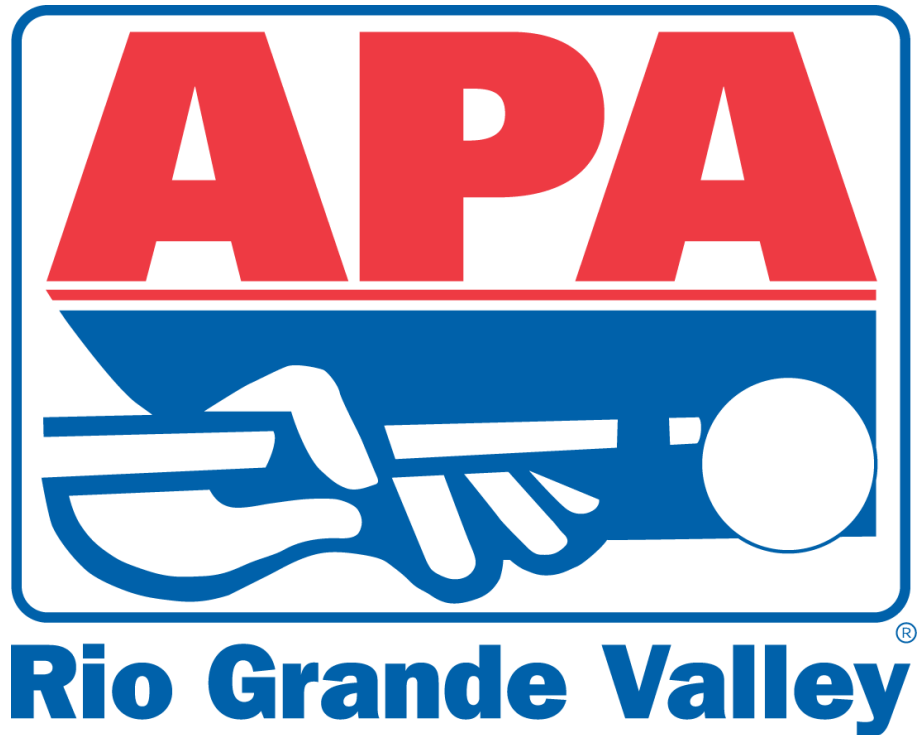




RIO GRANDE VALLEY APA BYLAWS

League Operator:

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These Bylaws have been approved by the American Poolplayers Association, Inc. The Local Bylaws are a secondary source of information created in accordance with, and in addition to, the Official Team Manual. The Official Team Manual will be your primary source of information and all rules in the Official Team Manual will be followed, with the exception of any revisions as listed below.

OFFICE HOURS are 12:00 p.m. to 9:00 p.m., Monday through Friday. If no one is available, please leave your name, phone number, team number and a brief message and you will be contacted as soon as possible.

LEAGUE PLAY START TIME is at 7:30pm Monday -Thursday, unless otherwise specified. Each team has 15 minutes after the start time to show up. After the 15 minutes you may start counting forfeits. Play will begin on time **even if only one player from a team is present**. Play must be continuous or forfeits will be awarded to the team that is present.

APA MEMBERSHIP DUES are due the first night a player plays **BUT NO LATER THAN the 4th week of the session**, whichever occurs first. If a player has not paid their APA membership dues by the 4th week of play, the player can be removed from the team's roster and the games that he or she won will be deducted from the team's total.

WEEKLY TEAM FEES are \$45.00 per week for 8-Ball and 9-Ball (\$9.00 per player). This may be paid via the APA app, Zelle and Apple Pay. This Weekly Team Fee is due for all scheduled matches, regardless of the number of games played, including **forfeits**, and division playoffs. Checks should be made payable to APA. There will be a \$35.00 charge for any returned check, plus loss of the Bonus Point. Checks returned from the bank for any reason must be picked up within 30 days or they will be turned over for collection. Once a bad check has been received from a player, the League Office reserves the right to refuse that individual's check in the future. Team Captains should not accept checks from anyone who is not an active member of their team. The team member's name should be preprinted on the check or the Team Captain should not accept the check. Checks written by team members should be **ONLY** for their individual fees and should not include other team member's fees.

ADDING NEW PLAYERS – Players wishing to join a team must have a membership set up online at poolplayers.com. **first night they play**. At that point captains can go in and add the player to the roster.

Teams may not add or drop players from the roster at any time during the session **EXCEPT** within the first 4 weeks of play in the session (BYE weeks do not count because players must be able to play at least 5 matches with the team). On very rare occasions of exceptional circumstance, the League Operator may grant a

team permission to add a player to its roster after the 4th week of play in the session. Examples of exceptions that will be considered are death, job relocation and military deployment. If you have to make a change after the 4th week and one of those ISN'T the reason then you may drop 2 players to replace one. Teams adding players past the 4th week of any Session should pay careful attention to the following rule regarding "Starting Skill Levels for New Players". Once a player is dropped from a roster, that player may not be added back to the same team's roster within the same session without League Operator approval. Teams that are eligible to participate in the World Qualifier may not make **ANY** changes to their Spring Session roster after the 4th week of the Spring Session.

STARTING SKILL LEVELS FOR NEW PLAYERS: The American Poolplayers Association was founded on the principle of fairness to all players. Therefore, accuracy of skill levels is very important. Team Captains are responsible for raising the Skill Level of any player on their team if the player's Skill Level is too low for any reason. Simply have the player play at their accurate Skill Level and write a note on the score sheet.

A team adding a NEW player who is known to have ability higher than the standard starting Skill Level must, in the interest of fairness, start the NEW player at their appropriate Skill Level. If a player's Skill Level should go up 2 or more skill levels in one session, penalties may be assessed against the offending team.

BONUS POINTS - (8ball bonus/9 ball bonus) 1 point/ 5 points- paperwork turned in on time and completed. 1point / 5 points- money turned in on time. 1 point / 5 points- both turned in on time. Each team will have the ability to receive 3 points in 8 ball and 15 points in 9 ball.

- To keep score we are utilizing the APA Scorekeeper App. If your team should choose to not use the electronic scoring system those teams are required to print out each scoresheet and send them via email to the league operator each night via email.
- If your team is keeping score on paper it must be **fully** and **legibly** complete the team's score sheets and collect all fees due for the week. We will allow **2** mistakes per sheet. If you there are any more mistakes you will not be receiving the bonus points.
- Any profanity written on the score sheets will result in an automatic loss of a point, if not more, dependent on the severity of comment. Please be respectful.

LOST SCORESHEETS AND/OR PACKETS - Team Captain should print out and keep two blank score sheets for use in the event that the score sheet and/or team packet are lost. In the event of a lost packet you are still required to turn in a score sheet with the proper amount of League dues, including weekly dues and membership fees with completed applications. Teams will be charged \$10 for replacement of lost team packets.

ABBREVIATIONS: to better communicate game results, please use the following abbreviations:

- 8 Ball Wrong Pocket = 8WP or 8OT
- Did Not Mark Pocket = DMP
- Early 8 = E8
- Scratch on 8 = SO8

FORFEITS - If a team fails to show up for a match, the opposing team (providing 5 players are present) will receive 2 points per match plus 1 bonus point in 8-Ball, and 15 points plus 20 bonus points in 9-Ball, provided all bonus point requirements are met.

Teams who give up full- team forfeit points must notify the League Office within two days of match play as to why they are giving up full-team forfeit points or they can be dropped from the schedule. Teams who do not show up for two consecutive weeks, and who do not contact the League Office, will be considered dropped from the League and a new schedule will be issued.

In the last 5 weeks of the session full team forfeits will only be worth 50 points in 9 ball and 8 points in 8 ball. Dropped teams and suspended players will forfeit all benefits, trophies, awards and prize money.

During playoffs all forfeits are worth 3 points for 8 Ball. During playoffs all forfeits are worth 20 points for 9 Ball.

POINTS FOR 8-BALL - Each day you will play a total of 5 matches. In each match you can win the maximum amount of 3 points. If you shut a player out (your opponent wins 0 games) your team will receive 3 points their team will receive 0 points. If your opponent wins 1 game but doesn't get to the hill you will win 2 points and their team will receive 2 points. If your opponent gets to the hill but you still win you will receive 2 points and their team will receive 1 point. The max

amount of points you can receive is 15 points a night plus your 1 bonus point. Any match forfeit during season is worth 2 points.

POINTS FOR 9-BALL -Each day you will play a total of 5 matches. In each match you can win the maximum amount of 20 points. The maximum amount of points your team can win is 100 points plus 20 bonus points. During session all forfeits are worth 15 points with your opposing team getting 0.

DROPPED TEAMS - Teams that drop out during the session will owe the balance of all weekly fees for the remainder of that session. If the balance is not paid in full, then each player who wishes to continue participating in the APA will pay their prorated portion of the uncollected fees. This applies even if the player is on more than one team, and remains active on the other team(s). Any team finishing a session and still owing uncollected weekly fees will pay the balance the first week of the following session. If the team does not sign up for the following session, any player from that team wishing to join another team will pay their prorated portion of the uncollected fees. If the player does not pay the amount they owe they will be ineligible for all playoff matches and WQC matches even if their team qualifies.

BALL IN HAND FOULS - The "Ball in Hand Fouls" are listed in the Official Team Manual. These are the **ONLY** fouls resulting in ball in hand. Any other type of violation of the rules is a sportsmanship violation. The League Office should be notified in writing as soon as possible. Warnings and penalties will be assessed as necessary at the discretion of the League Office. **BREAKING THE CUE STICK APART IS NOT A FOUL.**

BLUETOOTH DEVICES: Due to today's technology, we are letting you know that "earbuds", "headphones" or any "Bluetooth" devices are not allowed during regular League play or at any Higher Level Tournament.

BYES: When a new team is added to the schedule in the first 4 weeks of a session make-up matches will be scheduled between the new teams and those teams who had byes during the first 4 weeks. The make-up matches will then be scored to allow everyone an equal chance at the total points available in the session. This will also give all players the best opportunity to meet the number-of-matches-played eligibility requirements in regards to playoffs, WQC competition. Weekly fees are due on make-up matches. Beginning the 5th week, (8) points will be awarded for all byes in the 8-Ball League and (50) points will be awarded for all byes in the 9-Ball League.

TIME OUT – Time out has been called as soon as the player's coach or any other team member asks the player if they want a time out, or suggests to the player to take a time out. See the Official Team Manual for more information regarding coaching.

MARKING THE POCKET - A marker should be used when shooting the 8-ball to let your opponent know which pocket you are calling. In the event that you cannot find a marker, you may use an object foreign to the pool table. You may not use **table** chalk, money, drinks, lit cigarettes, weapons (including pocket knives), or any item deemed inappropriate by the Host Location. **THIS IS NOT A FOUL.**

SCOREKEEPING Scores will and must be kept by one of your team mates not by the person who is playing. If you choose to keep your own score and there is a dispute between teams, the team with a non-playing witness (someone else keeping score that isn't playing the individual match) will almost always be determined as having the correct score.

PLAYER SELECTION has been made for a particular match as soon as the opposing team has been notified of the player, and cannot be changed unless it is determined that the "23-Rule" will be violated.

HOLIDAY - Thanksgiving, Christmas and New Year's Eve will be off weeks unless specified otherwise.

TIE-BREAKERS -Ties will be broken according to the procedures outlined in the Official Team Manual. When teams are tied that never played each other during the session, the winner(s) will be determined to be the team(s) that earned the most points in the last four weeks of the session in which they played. If still tied, in order to meet time constraints, a coin toss will be used to determine the winner(s).

RESCHEDULED MATCHES - May be made up within two (2) weeks of the original match, unless pre-approved by the League Office. If not made up within two weeks, zero points will be awarded to both teams. Weekly Team Fees will be due for these matches. The League Office must be notified by BOTH TEAMS of any rescheduled matches at least 24 hours (1 day) in advance. Unless there is a major emergency during the day that would require a reschedule. There will be no rescheduling during the last (2) two weeks of the League session or during the playoffs. The only way to reschedule the last (2) two weeks of the League session is to play them in advance.

If you are the team asking for a reschedule, then you must be willing to go to the opposing teams Host Location to play, if requested. If a team walks out in the middle of a match, or for some reason refuses to play, that team will forfeit all points unless the team discusses the situation with the League Office PRIOR TO leaving the location.

Severe weather conditions or traveler's advisory warnings are a good enough reason for rescheduling team matches. Please contact the League Office with the date and time of the rescheduled match.

DOUBLE PLAY - is not mandatory. BUT if you do need to double play and the opposing team agrees to it the opposing team gets to PICK THE PLAYER who is to be doubled. Teams must let the opposing team know that they are needing to double play BEFORE the match starts so they can pick the player then. IF the team requesting the double play manages to get another player there they do not have to play that player twice.

SESSION PLAYOFFS - The League year is comprised of three Sessions: Summer, Fall and Spring. The week following the last week of the session will be the playoff week. There is a \$45.00 fee for playing in playoffs. Even if your team does not play the full match Only the teams that are in the playoffs need to show up that week. Every other team has the week off. The teams that finish 1st and 2nd will receive the prizes for their finish. Teams will play 1 round of playoffs. The rounds will proceed as follows.

Number Of Teams In The Division (last week of regular play)	World Qualifier (WQ) Qualification Playoff Structure	Session Award Structure
<u>4-5</u> One Team Qualifies For Tri-Annual	1 st Place vs Wildcard Winner Advances To Tri-Annual In a 4-team division, eligibility will not be passed to teams finishing directly behind an already qualified team in the Playoffs	Awards: Top Point Finisher will receive the 1 st Place Session trophies
<u>6-7</u> Two Teams Qualify For Tri-Annual	Division Point Leader advances directly to Tri-Annual 2 nd Place vs Wildcard Winner advances to Tri-Annual	Awards: Top Point Finisher will receive the 1 st Place Session trophies
<u>8-11</u> Three Teams Qualify For Tri-Annual	Division Point Leader advances directly to Tri-Annual 2 nd Place vs Wildcard 3 rd Place vs 4 th Place Both winners advance to Tri-Annual	Awards: Top Point Finisher will receive the 1 st Place Session trophies
<u>12-14</u> Four Teams Qualify For Tri-Annual	Division Point Leader advances directly to Tri-Annual 2 nd Place vs Wildcard 3 rd Place vs 6 th Place 4 th Place vs 5 th Place All winners advance to Tri-Annuals	Awards: Top Point Finisher will receive the 1 st Place Session trophies

<u>15-16</u> Five Teams Qualify For Tri-Annual	Division Point Leader advances directly to Tri-Annual 2nd Place vs Wildcard 3rd Place vs 8th Place 4th Place vs 7th Place 5th Place vs 6th Place All winners advance to Tri-Annuals	Awards: Top Point Finisher will receive the 1st Place Session trophies.
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1st and 2nd place finishers will receive trophies or plaques at the end of the session.

TRI-ANNUAL TOURNAMENT - This tournament will be held at the end of every session. Please refer to the table above.

Byes will be given to teams that are Qualified more than once for the World Qualifier if Byes are available. If there are multiple teams, it will be based on which team had more points through the League year.

WORLD QUALIFIER - In the Summer of every year, each team that qualified from the summer, fall and spring sessions will compete in the APA of the Rio Grande Valley World Qualifier Championships. Each member must have completed 5 games in each session. All matches need to be played in session. **YOU MAY NOT GET YOUR 5TH GAME IN PLAYOFFS.** Winners will have earned the right to compete for their share of the prize fund and a slot in the APA World Pool Championships held every year in August at the Westgate Hotel and Casino in Las Vegas, Nevada. Currently two 8-Ball teams and one 9-Ball team will advance to the APA World Pool Championship in Las Vegas. The format for the World Qualifier is modified single elimination, which means that each will have the opportunity to play at least twice, but not necessarily lose twice. Each winning 8-Ball team and 9-Ball team will receive travel assistance to Las Vegas for the World Pool Championship.

ELIGIBILITY – Refer to the Official Team Manual for rules regarding retaining your eligibility. Once a team has qualified for the World Qualifier Championship through the session playoffs, that team must retain (4) four original members in 8-Ball and 9-Ball. All teams that are qualified are subject to ALL the rules pertaining to eligibility, **INCLUDING** staying above the 50% in your division. Staying above the 50% is very important! If your team falls below the 50% there is a very likely chance your team will be unqualified from the World Qualifier Championship Tournament. If your team does lose their qualification you will be able to earn it again the following session.

TRAVEL PACKAGE - Each team advancing to the World Championships in Las Vegas, Nevada will receive a Travel Assistance Package. These funds are to assist with travel expenses. It is not prize money. If an eligible team, or any member of that team, should decide not to go to the World Pool Championship, that team or member will forfeit the travel funds.

AWARDS – All awards such as trophies/ team t-shirts will be given out every session. There will also be individuals that receive trophies for their play throughout the year. Travel assistance for events that receive it will be given out on the day of the tournament.

SHOWDOWN SERIES TOURNAMENTS - These tournaments will be qualifying 2-5 member teams for entry into the main event for that format in Las Vegas. They are in order as follows

- 8 Ball Scotch Doubles- 2
- Jack and Jill Doubles- 2
- 9 Ball Scotch Doubles- 2
- Team Captain Tournament- 5
- Ladies Tournament- 4
- Masters Tournament- 4

Travel Assistance will be paid to the team and the amount of payout will vary from year to year, dependent on the number of teams participating that tournament.

DOUBLES LEAGUE: Doubles league consists for 2-3 players per team. A 3rd player will only be able to be added within the first 6 weeks and cannot change. Doubles players will play one regular match and 1 doubles match. The fees for doubles is \$20 per team. To start a doubles division you **MUST** have 10 teams. This league plays like any other league night. There is only one time out per person per match. Only the players playing that night may give timeouts. IF your team has 3 players, the 2 players that played the majority of the matches will be the team that competes in playoffs or World Qualifier. If your team has to postpone a match you **MUST** notify the opposing team 24 hours in advance. Your team will have 2 weeks to make up the match and if you do not make it up in that amount of time both teams will receive 0 points. **ONLY 2 PLAYERS will go to Las Vegas.**

DESTINATION LEAGUE: This is a destination league that plays 2 weeks once a month. The monthly dues are \$15 per person/ \$75 per team. Since 2 weeks are played the total due is \$150 for the team. All same league rules apply. If you need to postpone a match you must inform the team 24 hours in advance. You will have 2 weeks after the date of play to make up the match. You may change rosters for the first 2 months. In this division, 1st and 2nd will automatically qualify for the Destination Regional. The winners of playoffs will also qualify and the number of teams at the playoffs will be determined by the number of teams playing in the session. Winners of playoffs will qualify for the Destination Regional event and for Spring Tri-Annual. IF there aren't at least 8 teams in each county, Cameron and Hidalgo will compete against each other. Since this is a Yearly Format, to be eligible for Aloha Regional Qualifier all players must have 5 matches played between December 1st and the end of the session for the Aloha division.

LATE FEES - Any team that falls two weeks behind in paying their dues may be dropped from the League for nonpayment. Dropped teams will forfeit all benefits, trophies, awards and prize money. Teams with past due fees will NOT receive patches, trophies, awards of any kind, and will **NOT** be eligible to participate in tournaments or other events hosted by Rio Grande Valley APA **UNTIL** the late fees have been paid.

BANNED PLAYERS - If a player has been banned from an APA location the team must play without that player. The APA does not have the right to insist that an APA player be admitted to that Host Location.

FALSIFICATION OF SCORESHEET - Any team caught sandbagging or sending in falsified scoresheets will be subject to any penalties determined by the League Operator, including but not limited to suspension from the League.

REFUSAL TO DO BUSINESS- At any time, at the sole discretion of the League Operator, Rio Grande Valley APA can refuse to do business with any individual regardless of whether the individual's APA membership is in good standing. Most often, players who are unwelcome in the League will be those who are disruptive to the League, repeatedly complain about handicaps or who otherwise deride the League in public.

99% of the circumstances that may lead to a dispute are covered in the Official Team Manual or these Bylaws. **DO NOT BECOME INVOLVED IN AN**

ARGUMENT!!! Any arguments that come to the League Office's attention will not be tolerated. If we hear about players yelling and fighting it will result in a loss of points on both ends. So please refer to the Official Team Manual, these bylaws or contact your Division Representative. If all else fails call your League Operator Erin Lacy at 956-821-6925.

REMEMBER to HAVE FUN. MEET PEOPLE. PLAY POOL.